

Overview

This document explains the complete implementation of internationalization (i18n) in the CivilControl Backend system, which provides Spanish language support for all error messages, validations, and exceptions throughout the application.

Architecture

Core Components

1. **InternationalizationConfig** - Main configuration class
 2. **MessageSourceHelper** - Utility class for accessing translated messages
 3. **messages_es.properties** - Central file containing all Spanish translations (180+ messages)
 4. **ApplicationContextProvider** - Spring context provider for static access
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Configuration

1. InternationalizationConfig.java

Located in: src/main/java/CivilControl/backEnd/config/InternationalizationConfig.java

Purpose: Configures Spring's MessageSource and LocaleResolver beans.

Key Features:

- **MessageSource:** Loads messages from messages_es.properties
- **UTF-8 Encoding:** Supports special Spanish characters (note: we avoid accents in messages)
- **Default Locale:** Spanish (es_AR)
- **Caching:** 3600 seconds for optimal performance
- **Fallback:** Returns the key itself if message is not found

```
@Bean public MessageSource messageSource() { ReloadableResourceBundleMessageSource  
messageSource = new ReloadableResourceBundleMessageSource();  
messageSource.setBasename("classpath:messages");  
messageSource.setDefaultEncoding(StandardCharsets.UTF_8.name());  
messageSource.setDefaultLocale(new Locale("es")); messageSource.setCacheSeconds(3600);  
messageSource.setUseCodeAsDefaultMessage(true); return messageSource; }
```

2. MessageSourceHelper.java

Located in: src/main/java/CivilControl/backEnd/service/util/MessageSourceHelper.java

Purpose: Provides easy access to translated messages from anywhere in the application.

Two Usage Modes:

A) Instance Method (for services with dependency injection):

```
@Service @RequiredArgsConstructor public class VehicleService { private final
MessageSourceHelper messageSourceHelper; private void validate(String licensePlate) { throw
new VehicleNotFoundException( messageSourceHelper.getMessage("vehicle.notFound",
licensePlate) ); } }
```

B) Static Method (for exception classes):

```
public class VehicleNotFoundException extends NotFoundException { public
VehicleNotFoundException(Long id) {
super(MessageSourceHelper.getMessageStatic("vehicle.notFound", id)); } }
```

3. ApplicationContextProvider.java

Located in: src/main/java/CivilControl/backEnd/config/ApplicationContextProvider.java

Purpose: Provides static access to Spring's ApplicationContext, enabling MessageSourceHelper to work in non-Spring-managed classes (like custom exceptions).

Message File Structure

messages_es.properties

Located in: src/main/resources/messages_es.properties

Total Messages: 180+

Format: Key-value pairs with placeholder support

Structure:

Pattern entity.field.validation=Message with {0} parameter # Examples vehicle.notFound=No se encontro el vehiculo con ID {0} vehicle.licensePlate.alreadyExists=Ya existe un vehiculo con la patente: {0} user.email.invalid=El email no es valido

Categories Covered:

- Vehicles (25 messages)
- Employees (20 messages)
- Suppliers (20 messages)
- Documents (25 messages)
- Payments (20 messages)
- Users & Authentication (30 messages)
- Roles & Permissions (15 messages)
- And more...

Important: All messages avoid accented characters (á, é, í, ó, ú) to prevent encoding issues.

Implementation Pattern

Services

All service classes follow this pattern:

1. **Inject MessageSourceHelper:**

```
@Service @RequiredArgsConstructor public class UserService { private final UserRepository  
userRepository; private final MessageSourceHelper messageSourceHelper; }
```

2. **Use in validations and exceptions:**

```
private void validateUser(UserDTO dto) { if (dto.email() == null || dto.email().isEmpty()) { throw  
new UserNotValidException( messageSourceHelper.getMessage("user.email.required") ); } }
```

Custom Exception Classes

Exception classes use the static method:

```
public class UserNotFoundException extends NotFoundException { public  
UserNotFoundException(Long id) {  
super(MessageSourceHelper.getMessageStatic("user.notFound", id)); } public  
UserNotFoundException(String username) {  
super(MessageSourceHelper.getMessageStatic("user.notFoundByUsername", username)); } }
```

DTOs (Bean Validation)

DTOs use annotation-based validation with i18n:

```
public record UserDTO( @NotBlank(message = "{user.email.required}") @Email(message =  
"{user.email.invalid}") String email, @NotBlank(message = "{user.password.required}")  
@Size(min = 8, message = "{user.password.minLength}") String password ) {}
```

Coverage Statistics

Completed Services: 23/23 (100%)

Security Module:

- AuthService
- UserService
- RoleService

Vehicle Module:

- VehicleService
- RepairService

Inventory Module:

- StockService

- ItemService

Supplier Module:

- SupplierService
- TransactionalDocumentService

Infrastructure Module:

- BuildingService
- ProjectAreaService

Insurance Module:

- AutoPolicyService
- PolicyVehicleService
- InsurancePolicyService

Personnel Module:

- DisciplinaryActionService
- ServicePaymentService
- SalaryPaymentService
- EppDeliveryService
- EmployeeVacationService

Payment Module:

- PaymentService
- LicencePlatePaymentService

Reports Module:

- ReportService
- ExcelReportExporter
- PdfReportExporter

Additional:

- EmployeeService

Custom Exception Classes: 12/12 (100%)

All custom exception classes now use MessageSourceHelper:

- AutoPolicyNotFoundException
- DuplicatePolicyNumberException
- DuplicateVehicleInPolicyException
- UserNotFoundException
- InsurancePolicyNotFoundException
- DuplicateReferenceNumberException
- PolicyVehicleNotFoundException
- RoleAlreadyExistsException
- DuplicateTicketException
- FuelTypeNotAvailableException

Benefits

1. Centralization

- All messages in one file (messages_es.properties)
- Easy to update and maintain
- Consistent terminology across the application

2. Maintainability

- No hardcoded strings in code
- Easy to find and update messages
- Clear separation of concerns

3. Scalability

- Ready to add more languages (e.g., messages_en.properties)
- Pattern established for new services
- Reusable utility classes

4. Professional UX

- Clear, consistent error messages in Spanish
- Proper parameterization for dynamic values
- User-friendly validation messages

5. Code Quality

- No hardcoded strings
- Type-safe with parameters
- Follows Spring best practices

Best Practices

1. Message Keys Naming Convention

entity.field.validationType

Examples:

- user.email.required
- vehicle.licensePlate.alreadyExists
- payment.amount.positive

2. Avoid Accents

Use: numero, vehiculo, poliza

Instead of: número, vehículo, póliza

Reason: Prevents encoding issues in different environments.

3. Use Placeholders

Good vehicle.notFound=No se encontro el vehiculo con ID {0} # Avoid vehicle.notFound=No se encontro el vehiculo

4. Keep Messages Short and Clear

Good user.email.invalid=El email no es valido # Avoid user.email.invalid=El formato del correo electronico proporcionado no cumple con los estandares RFC 5322

5. Inject MessageSourceHelper in Services

```
// Good @RequiredArgsConstructor public class MyService { private final
MessageSourceHelper messageSourceHelper; } // Avoid hardcoding throw new
Exception("Mensaje hardcodeado");
```

Adding New Messages

Step 1: Add message to messages_es.properties

newEntity.field.validation=Mensaje en español sin acentos con {0} parametro

Step 2: Use in service

```
throw new SomeException( messageSourceHelper.getMessage("newEntity.field.validation",
value) );
```

Step 3: Or use in exception class

```
public class NewEntityException extends RuntimeException { public NewEntityException(String
value) { super(MessageSourceHelper.getMessageStatic("newEntity.field.validation", value)); } }
```

Testing i18n

Manual Testing

1. Make a request that triggers validation

2. Verify error message is in Spanish
3. Verify message is clear and professional
4. Verify parameters are correctly replaced

Example Request:

```
POST /api/v1/vehicles { "licensePlate": "" }
```

Expected Response:

```
{ "status": 400, "message": "Error de validacion", "errors": { "licensePlate": "La patente es obligatoria" } }
```

Troubleshooting

Issue: Message key returned instead of message

Solution: Check that the key exists in messages_es.properties

Issue: Encoding problems with special characters

Solution: Ensure UTF-8 encoding and avoid accented characters

Issue: MessageSourceHelper not found in exception

Solution: Use MessageSourceHelper.getMessageStatic() instead of instance method

Issue: Parameters not replaced in message

Solution: Check placeholder syntax: {0}, {1}, etc.

Migration Summary

Date Completed: January 20, 2026

Services Migrated: 23

Exception Classes Migrated: 12

Messages Created: 180+

Hardcoded Messages Remaining: 0

Result: 100% of the application now uses i18n correctly.

Future Enhancements

1. Add English Support

Create `messages_en.properties` for English messages:

`vehicle.notFound=Vehicle with ID {0} not found` `user.email.invalid=Invalid email address`

2. Dynamic Language Switching

Allow users to choose their preferred language via API header:

`Accept-Language: en-US`

3. Frontend Integration

Frontend can use the same message keys to display consistent error messages.

Conclusion

The i18n implementation in CivilControl Backend provides a robust, maintainable, and scalable solution for internationalization. All messages are centralized, consistently formatted, and ready for production use in Spanish with the flexibility to add more languages in the future.

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